

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. (OCBC.SI): NDR takeaways: Focus on delivering more synergies as One Group; Buy

We hosted OCBC CEO Helen Wong and CFO Goh Chin Yee for an NDR in Europe. Investors' discussions with management focused not only on financial performance but also on how the bank is positioning itself to capture growth opportunities in Asia's (especially Singapore's) expanding wealth management landscape. Management sees the strategic priority of its One Group strategy as key to delivering stronger wealth franchise to capture growth opportunities and to deliver stronger ROEs as it strives to drive closer collaboration between OCBC Bank, Bank of Singapore (BOS) and Great Eastern Holdings (GEH) to unlock synergies across income, cost and balance sheet management. Near term, management reaffirmed confidence in achieving its FY 2025 guidance where it prioritizes NII over NIM and expects it to decline by mid-single digit with credit cost coming in at 20-25bps, asset quality remaining resilient, and Wealth Management a key driver for non-NII growth.

Melissa Kuang, CFA
+65-6889-2869 |
melissa.kuang@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Singapore) Pte

Key takeaways include:

#1: Driving for synergies through its One Group strategy fostering closer collaboration across OCBC Bank, Bank of Singapore (BOS) and Great Eastern Holdings (GEH) as well as across its regional markets. This approach aims to unlock synergies on both the income and cost fronts. On the income side, OCBC sees opportunities such as to deepen integration between BOS and the bank's treasury operations, allowing BOS to source more products internally. Collaboration with GEH is also being strengthened to co-develop tailored insurance and investment solutions for both BOS and OCBC clients. On the cost side, focus will be on operational centralisation. Additionally, management continues to drive group wide integration in areas such as balance sheet management, AML and capital optimisation to enhance efficiency.

#2: Prioritizing NII over NIMs amid a falling rate environment. OCBC sees opportunities through strong deposit growth particularly in low cost deposits which can be deployed into interest earnings assets, and in this environment, where loan growth remains muted, there will be greater deployment into investment assets which though NIM dilutive is nonetheless NII accretive. As of 1H25, deposits rose 4% YTD and 10%yoy; management expects this momentum to continue, supported by its growth in SME operating accounts, retail deposits and wealth management AUM wins. OCBC also notes there will be some NII support from a repricing of deposits given the lag in repricing vs loans. Overall, the banks reiterates that it remains on track to deliver a mid single digit decline in NII for FY2025.

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#3: Boosting Non-NII with focus on Wealth Management to cushion pressure on NII in a falling rate environment. Management expects AUM growth to remain robust and it continues to see good inflow of AUM into Singapore. Furthermore, OCBC sees opportunities to further expand in the affluent segment in HK and continues to build up its presence in WM in Malaysia, Indonesia and China. OCBC also sees room to enhance WM fees by expanding its suite of in-house investment products and deepening the collaboration between Bank of Singapore and OCBC's treasury division. Great Eastern will contribute to this strategy working more closely with BOS on integrated wealth and insurance offerings. Overall management anticipates double digit fee income growth from wealth management.

#4. Asset quality remains resilient with no areas of systemic concerns. While commercial real estate (CRE) continues to be an area of close monitoring, OCBC notes that it continues to reduce its exposure in the segment with exposure to HK mid-tier CRE borrowers modest at S\$3bn (1% of loan book). Provisioning levels are also viewed as adequate, supported by strong performing loan coverage of 89bps. As such management remains confident that credit cost will remain within the 20-25bps range for FY2025.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp.

We are Buy rated on OCBC with a 12-month target price of S\$20.0 (based on a two-stage DDM). Key risks include: (-) Sudden or sharper-than-expected Fed cut cycle; (-) Changes in strategy to return capital; (-) Unexpected dilutive M&A activity.

OCBC - Investment thesis

We are Buy-rated on OCBC given its undemanding valuation, trading at 1 st.dev above its historical 10-year median P/B, with average ROAs holding up at 1.2% on average for 2025-27E, higher than historical average of 1.0%, as we expect margin to be more resilient in this rate cut cycle. Furthermore, we view positively OCBC's willingness to now focus on capital optimization, and we anticipate OCBC to increase its dividend payout ratio to 59% in 2027E. This has not taken into account the S\$4bn excess capital of OCBC bank and S\$2.4bn excess capital of GEH. We noticed that OCBC has shown significant progress on capital optimization in other subsidiaries since 2021, capital was upstreamed to the OCBC group level from local operating entities, and we expect OCBC to better utilize the excess capital to fund profitable growth or return to shareholders. We wait for management to provide more updates on the group's capital planning after the GEH general offer is closed.

OCBC.SI		12m Price Target: S\$20.00		Price: S\$16.86		Upside: 18.6%	
Buy		GS Forecast					
Market cap: S\$75.6bn / \$58.2bn 3m ADTV: S\$89.3mn / \$69.5mn Singapore Asean Financials M&A Rank: 3			12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E	
		Net inc. (\$ mn)	7,587.0	6,823.5	7,058.9	7,498.5	
		EPS (\$\$)	1.68	1.52	1.58	1.67	
		EPS growth (%)	8.1	(9.4)	3.5	6.2	
		P/E (X)	8.6	11.1	10.7	10.1	
		P/B (X)	1.1	1.3	1.2	1.2	
		ROA (%)	1.3	1.1	1.0	1.1	
		ROE (%)	13.7	11.7	11.8	12.0	
		Price/PPOP (X)	8.7	9.3	9.2	8.7	
		Dividend yield (%)	7.0	5.9	5.9	6.0	
			6/25	9/25E	12/25E	3/26E	
		EPS (\$\$)	0.40	0.37	0.32	0.40	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 9 Oct 2025 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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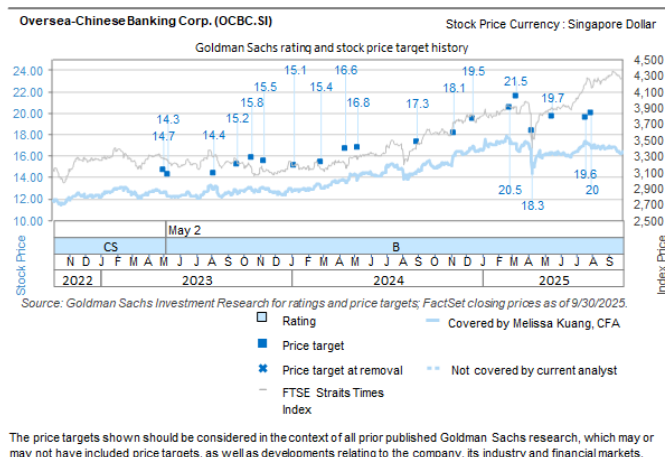
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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